

The Verses of Auspiciousness, Requested by a God

Devaparipṛcchā Maṅgalagāthā · Toh 819 · Derge Kangyur

ལྷ་མཆོད་པའི་བེད་ལེགས་ཀྱི་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་སྤྱུང་པ།

The Verses of Auspiciousness, Requested by a God (Sanskrit: Devaparipṛcchā Maṅgalagāthā; Tibetan: lha yis zhus pa'i bkra shis kyi tshigs su bcad pa) is a short discourse in verse that takes up the question of what truly constitutes good fortune. It opens with a god, described as a great hero, who pays homage to the Buddha and asks him to name the truly supreme auspiciousness, noting that gods and humans alike each speak of their own favorable signs. The Blessed One answers in verse, and the text closes with a wish that those who have fully entered into the buddhas' realization, abandoning all that is to be abandoned, will all come to enjoy well-being. It is Toh 819 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the Tantra section, and it is a brief text of auspicious verses, in the manner of a sutra-style dialogue.

Those who have fully entered into the buddhas' realization, abandoning all that is to be abandoned, will all come to enjoy well-being. Here ends the verse of auspiciousness that brings well-being.

In the language of India: Devaparipṛcchā Maṅgalagāthā. In the language of Tibet: The Verses of Auspiciousness, Requested by a God.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

When the Protector, the perfectly awakened Buddha whom no other can overcome, was dwelling in one place, a certain god, a great hero, paid homage to him and spoke these words:

"Those who seek what is virtuous, gods and humans alike, each speak of auspicious signs. Tell us, then, what is the truly supreme auspiciousness?"

The Blessed One declared:

"Those who seek what is virtuous, gods and humans alike, each speak of auspicious signs. Of those, let the auspicious be told.

To dwell in a good land, to have the finest companions, to have done meritorious deeds in the past, and to have set one's mind rightly: this is supreme auspiciousness.

Generosity and gentle, pleasing speech, firm certainty in the true meaning, and keeping company with those of moral discipline: this is supreme auspiciousness.

Not relying on fools, relying on the wise, and honoring those worthy of honor: this is supreme auspiciousness.

Serving and revering one's father and mother, peacefulness and pure conduct, and compassion for all beings: this is supreme auspiciousness.

Turning away from harmful actions, devoting oneself to virtuous actions, being conscientious, and always being skillful: this is supreme auspiciousness.

Being without pride and arrogance, living contentedly and in harmony, and always being mindful of the kindness one has received: this is supreme auspiciousness.

Generosity, and likewise patience, harmony with the noble ones, and listening to the Dharma at the proper times: this is supreme auspiciousness.

Freedom from laziness, great learning, firm certainty in the Dharma, and likewise a mind free of turbulence: this is supreme auspiciousness.

To cultivate, as one's very root, a loving mind toward all sentient beings, immeasurable and unshaken: this is supreme auspiciousness.

To have the eye of wisdom purified regarding the truths of the noble ones, and to have unimpaired moral discipline: this is supreme auspiciousness.

To see the truths of the noble ones, to cultivate pure conduct, and to be bound to attain nirvāṇa: this is supreme auspiciousness.

To abandon completely attachment, aversion, and ignorance, and to give rise to unshakable knowing: this is supreme auspiciousness.

Though touched by the worldly conditions, one whose mind does not waver, who is free of stain, serene, and without sorrow: this is supreme auspiciousness.

Thus, as is fitting, in this way that auspiciousness..."

Translator's Notes

- The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, so the final line is left unfinished. The opening fragment belongs to the close of a preceding text, and its first line is cut off. The transliterated Sanskrit title is slightly corrupt; it reflects Devaparipṛcchā-maṅgalagāthā. The "worldly conditions" are the eight worldly dharmas: gain and loss, fame and disrepute, praise and

blame, pleasure and pain.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.